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Section Title(S): SIB EXOGAMY AND CROSS-COUSIN MARRIAGE

In the second of the above cases, he cannot marry because "children" of the same sib are considered to be brothers and sisters to one another. As regards the third and fourth cases, I have heard it said that nowadays marriage is taking place between such members of joking relationship sib's and also between members of sibs of common origin, but I do not know how true this is, for it must be very new, and I am not acquainted with any specific instance. It may be that the Christians are breaking this rule.

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Cross-cousins, as we have stated supra, call each other *binam* or *mtani*. They are *binam* to each other. According to the aboriginal pagan usages of many tribes, including the Walaguru and the neighboring Wanguru, the proper person for one to marry is his or her *binam* or cross-cousin. This cross-cousin may be either the father's sister's child or the mother's brother's child. I do not wish however to imply that actually cross-cousin always marries cross-cousin. A person may, under the conditions and with the exceptions noted in the paragraph before the last, marry whomsoever he chooses.

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Whether or not some of the underdevelopment and other physical peculiarities and defects noticeable in the Walaguru are traceable, through the emergence of recessive traits into dominants, to such inbreeding, I am in no position to decide and do not wish to imply. I merely bring up the point to emphasize that the natives themselves do not seem to consider such possible effects, if they believe in them at all, of real importance. The Walaguru have three strong reasons or rationalizations for preferential cross-cousin marriage. These reasons are economic, social, and religious. A few words regarding each of these three.

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First, the *economic* reasons. In any case of cross-cousin marriage the father of the boy and the father of the girl are extremely  66 well related. Take the case of a boy marrying the daughter of his maternal uncle, and first of all as regards the bride price, which in marriages in general is paid to the father of the girl and to the maternal uncle and other relatives of the girl. We know that the maternal uncle of the boy is to all intents and purposes the head of the family to which the boy belongs, and he is likewise of course the partial head of his own family including his daughter. The bride price has to be paid in marriages in general by the boy's father, or, if the father cannot pay it, the maternal uncle is expected to come to the aid of his maternal nephew. Because of the bond, in the type of cross-cousin we are assuming, between *mjomba* (maternal uncle) and *mpwa* (maternal nephew), the *mjomba* can hardly in fairness ask money or payment from his own *mpwa*. As a matter of fact he does not actually ask for his share of the bride price as father of the girl. Thus the boy's father has only to procure and pay over the portion of the bride price due to the girl's maternal uncle (her *mjomba*) and to his (her *mjomba's*) relatives. Nowadays the father of the boy is due to pay about thirty shillings to the girl's *mjomba* and the *mjomba's* relatives. If his boy were being married to a stranger, a girl not his cross-cousin, the boy's father would have to pay out more than double that amount as the bride price.

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